

IAS PRELIMS 2020

STATE BY STATE



LAKSHADWEEP

DEMOGRAPHICAL

GEOGRAPHICAL

ENVIRONMENTAL

CULTURAL

MODULE - 14

1

HIGHS AND LOWS



1

India's smallest Union Territory.

2

One of the four major coral reef regions in India.

3

Agatti Aerodrome is the only domestic airport in Lakshadweep. (Aviation Fuel Station is commissioned recently)

4

Bangaram and Suheli islands are under Protected Area Permit regime. Indian nationals and foreigners need to obtain the entry permit for Agatti Island.

5

One of the only two Indian administrative divisions with a Muslim majority (the other being the Jammu and Kashmir).

6

Pitti Island, is an important breeding place for sea turtles and for a number of pelagic birds.

7

Andrott is the nearest island to the mainland and Largest island in the Lakshadweep

STATE BY STATE ... LAKSHADWEEP

2

LATITUDES

LAKSHADWEEP

- Group of 36 islands having an area of 32 sq. kms and extending between 8° N and 12° N latitude.
- 8 Degree Channel (8° N latitude) separates islands of Minicoy and Maldives.
- 9 Degree Channel (9° N latitude) separates the island of Minicoy from the main Lakshadweep archipelago.
- 11° N latitude divides erstwhile Amindivi islands and Cannanore Islands/Laccadive Islands.

9 DEGREE CHANNEL

MINICOY

8 DEGREE CHANNEL

SRI LANKA

MALDIVES

KOZHIKODE

- India's only coral atolls and geologically part of the same chain as the Maldives.
- Do not show any major topographical features such as hills, streams, valleys, etc. but are largely low levelled and flat topped, generally rising to the height of a few metres above sea level.
- Archipelago consisting of 12 atolls, 3 reefs and 5 submerged banks. Almost all the inhabited islands are coral atolls.

KOCHI

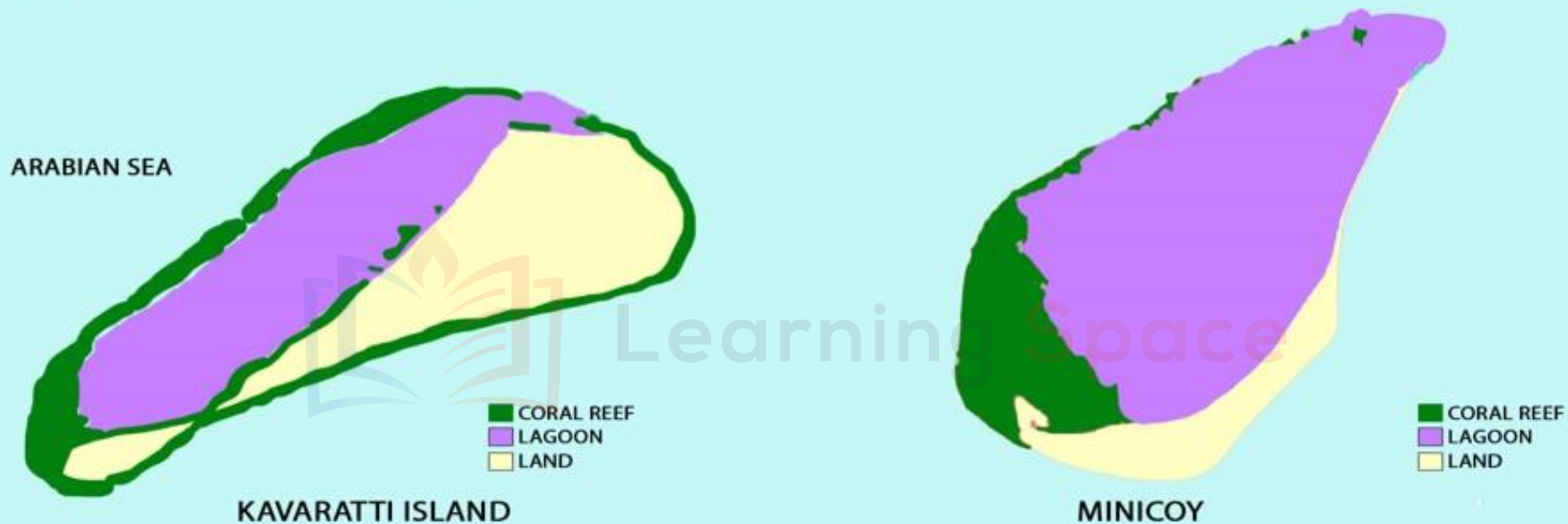




KOZHIKODE

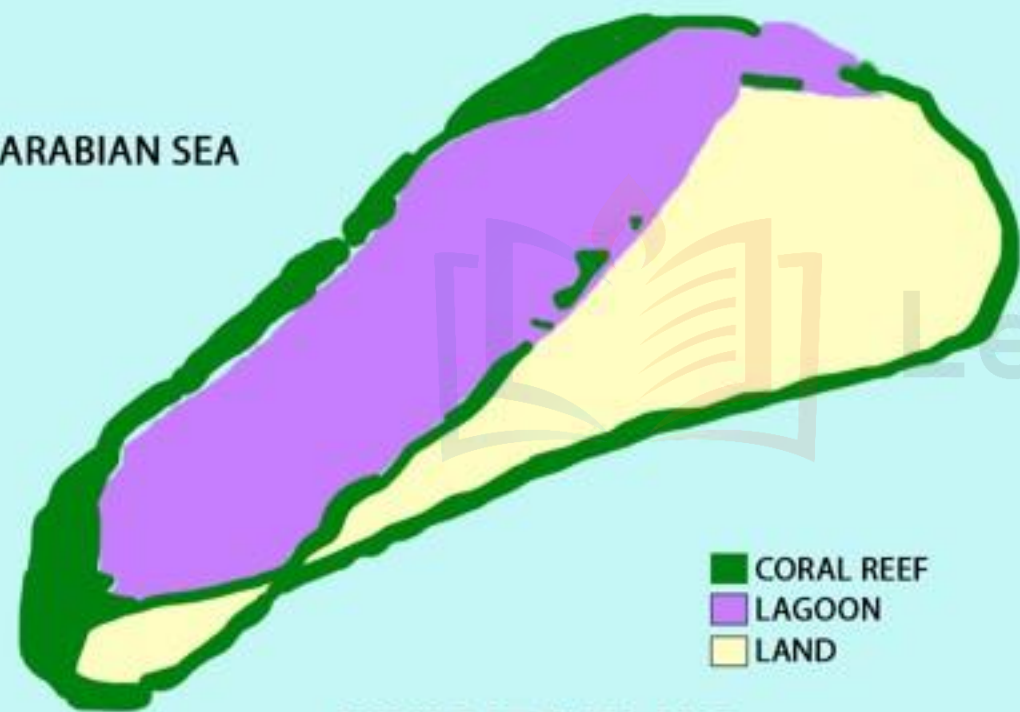
- Uni-district UT and is comprised of comprised of 10 inhabited islands, 17 uninhabited islands, 4 newly formed islets and 5 submerged reefs.
- Kavaratti is the administrative capital and also principal town.
- Under the jurisdiction of the Kerala High Court.
- Has no representation in Rajya Sabha.

KOCHI



- Most atolls have a northeast-southwest orientation with an island on the east, a broad, well- developed reef on the west and a lagoon in between.
- The cyclones from the east have piled up coral debris on the eastern reef while the very high waves generated during the southwest monsoon have broken the reef into coarse and subsequently to fine sediments. These are then transported and deposited on the eastern side behind the coral boulders and pebbles on the eastern reef.
- A gradual accretion of sediments by this process has led to the growth of the islands.

ARABIAN SEA



KAVARATTI ISLAND

CORAL REEF
LAGOON
LAND



MINICOY

CORAL REEF
LAGOON
LAND

The higher eastern sides of the islands are the most suited for human habitation, while the low-lying lagoons on the western sides protect the inhabitants from the southwest monsoon.

- Minicoy Island is the southernmost island.
- Maldives' northernmost Thuraakunu Island is just 100 km from the Indian naval station in Minicoy.

KOZHIKODE

- No streams or major surface water bodies.
- Brackish water ponds exist at Bangaram and Minicoy.
- Delicate ecosystem with very limited fresh water resources.
- Despite high rainfall, the lack of surface storage and the limited ground water storage capacity makes fresh water a precious commodity.
- Population pressure, freshwater contamination with waste water further increased the water stress.

KOCHI



KOZHIKODE



- Soils are mainly derived from coral limestone and include coral sands and lagoon sands and muds.
- Soils over most of the islands are highly permeable and allow rainfall to readily infiltrate, with the result that surface run-off does not occur except in local areas of compacted soils.
- Less permeable soils in some areas result in ponded water after rainfall.

KOCHI

STATE BY STATE ... LAKSHADWEEP

6

RAINFALL

- Southwest monsoon period is the main rainy season which lasts from late May to October.
- Cyclones moving across the Arabian Sea rarely strike the islands.
- However, the winds and waves associated with them can alter the land features considerably.



Climate: Have a tropical humid, warm climate.



- Coconut is the only major crop in all the islands.
- Plantain and vegetables are grown in small patches of low-lying lands.
- Copra is produced and exported to the mainland.
- Fishing also forms a major segment of the territory's economy, with tuna as the primary catch.
- Forests and mineral deposits are absent. (As per Ministry of MSME, Brief industrial profile of Lakshadweep report)

LAKSHADWEEP

WLS - WILDLIFE SANCTUARY

KERALA

PITTI (BIRD ISLAND) WLS

Arabian Sea

- Important breeding place for sea turtles and for a number of pelagic birds such as the Brown Noddy, Lesser Crested Tern and the Greater Crested Tern.
- Pitti island has been declared a bird sanctuary.

KOLKALI AND PARICHAKALI



- Kolkali and Parichakali are the two popular folk art forms.
- They are an integral part of the cultural milieu except in Minicoy where "LAVA" is the most popular dance form.

LAVA DANCE



- Performed by the males.
- Performers' first line up themselves in pairs or singles carrying drums, and start a dance according to the beating of the drums
- Similar to the 'Maldiva Bileh dhafi negun'.
- Other specialized dances of the Minicoy Island are Dandi Dance, Bandiya Dance and Fuli Dance.



- Entire indigenous population has been classified as Scheduled Tribes because of their economic and social backwardness.
- No Scheduled Castes in this Union Territory.
- Malayalam is spoken in all the islands except Minicoy where people speak Mahl which is written in Divehi script and is spoken in Maldives also.

SEA-CUCUMBERS



- Single-branched marine invertebrates, ranging in length from 1.9 centimetres to more than 6 feet.
- Found at the bottom of lagoons and the ocean floor.
- High demand across Southeast Asia (mainly China), for use in dishes and traditional medicine.
- Listed under Schedule I of the Wildlife Protection Act (WPA), 1972, akin to the protection for tigers, leopards or elephants.
- Also have protection under CITES.

STATUS AND PROTECTION OF CORAL REEFS (STAPCOR)



The poster for STAPCOR 2018 features logos of the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of India, Lakshadweep Administration, and IUCN. The text reads: **STAPCOR 2018** (Status and Protection of Coral Reefs). The event is scheduled for **October 22, 2018** at **TIME - 10.30 AM**. It is the **Inauguration of International Conference on STAPCOR 2018** organized by the Department of Environment and Forest, Union Territory of Lakshadweep Administration at **Bangaram Island, Lakshadweep**. The program includes:

- Interaction with Coral Scientists of the world.
- Exploration of Marine Biodiversity by scuba diving and snorkeling
- Laying Foundation stone of OTEC Plant at Kavaratti

 A portrait of a man in a red vest is shown at the bottom right. Social media handles and the website www.drharshvardhan.in are listed at the bottom.

- *International Conference on Status and Protection of Coral Reefs (STAPCOR 2018) was held at Bangaram Island.*
- *Theme for STAPCOR 2018: "Reef for Life".*
- *Organised by the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) in co-ordination with the local administration.*
- *This is the 3rd STAPCOR event following those in 1998, and 2008 in celebration and support of the International Year of the Reef.*
- *Promote partnerships between governments, academia, civil society and the private sector to encourage the sharing of information and best practices for the future of sustainable coral reef management.*

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RECENT NEWS

PARALI-I ISLAND



- *Parali-I Island is part of Bangaram Atoll.*
- *One of biodiversity-rich uninhabited islands part of Lakshadweep has disappeared due to coastal erosion and another four such islands in Lakshadweep sea are shrinking fast.*
- *Study: "Studies on coastal erosion in selected uninhabited islands of Lakshadweep archipelago Archipelago with Special Reference to Biodiversity Conservation."*

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RECENT NEWS

INS DWEEPRAKSHAK



- Indian Navy commissioned a full-fledged naval base, INS Dweepprakash, at Kavaratti.
- Objective: To maintain effective coastal surveillance and defence capability.
- With rising threat to Indian shipping lanes, such as attacks by Somali pirates, the island territory has grown in significance to Indian security considerations.
- INS Dweepprakash was therefore established to facilitate the Indian Navy to offer surveillance potentialities and amenities to Indian naval vessels on patrol.

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